A flank patrol of 4 Garhwal which had left the locality on 15 November, came in on the radio at 7.15 a.m., reporting that approximately two infantry battalions were forming up opposite the Alpha Company locality while another large body of troops seemed to heading there from the direction of Jang to further reinforce them. Half an hour later, Chinese artillery and heavy mortars opened up, followed shortly by waves of Chinese soldiers. Owing to the covering fire, the Chinese managed to get fairly close to the Indian defences. The Garhwalis, relying mainly on grenades, broke up this attack successfully and the Chinese withdrew once again.

This was the classic method of defence on which the Indian Army relied and the Garhwalis were in their element. The main problem was that no matter how many men they dropped, the Chinese kept coming—a line of men would replace their fallen soldiers. Sooner or later the well-entrenched Indian troops would run out of ammunition.

The forward platoon under Udai Singh was the most affected as the main thrust of the Chinese attack had been aimed at this platoon. The Chinese were constantly attacking Alpha Company with mortars and artillery fire as more guns were being brought across the repaired Bridge 4. A message was relayed to Battalion HQ asking for more ammunition. Second Lieutenant Vinod Goswami volunteered to carry the ammunition to Udai Singh. In addition, through the rest of the day, the battalion's quartermaster, Captain P. P. S. Bains, kept up a steady supply of ammunition to replenish the forward positions.

The Chinese had no choice but to try and force their way through Alpha Company to get to the other companies deployed behind them in the narrow valley. Having regrouped, they launched the third assault at 9.10 a.m.; again they were beaten back. Thereupon a lull in the fighting ensued. The Chinese in the meantime seemed to have pushed forward a fairly competent artillery officer to act as the FOO, for accurate counter- bombardment started coming onto the Derajat Battery gun positions. At first some of the gunners broke ranks, but the GPO, Lieutenant Charanjit 'Cherry' Dhillon, quickly brought the situation under control and the guns continued to be fully active.

At 10 a.m., the increased tempo in the shelling suggested that the Chinese were going to attack for a fourth time. Half an hour later, after the bombardment lifted, Chinese infantry launched a three-pronged attack, trying to get at the Indians from the exposed west flank of Alpha Company.